

Star Players of Indian Cricket (Post-2000)

Sachin Tendulkar

Sachin Tendulkar is a right-handed batsman who played for India from 1989 to 2013. Widely called the 'God of Cricket', he remained India's talisman well past 2000, going on to become the first and only player to score 100 international centuries and the highest run-scorer in both Test and ODI history. He was a central figure in India's 2011 ICC Cricket World Cup triumph, achieved in his home city of Mumbai. In Test cricket he played 200 matches and scored 15,921 runs, and in ODIs he played 463 matches and scored 18,426 runs. In 2014 he was awarded the Bharat Ratna, India's highest civilian honour.

Sourav Ganguly

Sourav Ganguly is a left-handed batsman who captained the Indian cricket team and played from 1992 to 2008. As captain from 2000, Ganguly rebuilt Indian cricket's confidence after the match-fixing scandal, backing young talent like Yuvraj Singh, Zaheer Khan and MS Dhoni. Known as the 'Prince of Kolkata', his aggressive leadership took India to the 2003 World Cup final. He played 113 Test matches, scoring 7,212 runs, and 311 ODIs, scoring 11,363 runs. He led India to 49 Test wins as captain and is remembered for his shirt-waving celebration at Lord's during the 2002 NatWest Series final.

Rahul Dravid

Rahul Dravid is a right-handed batsman who played for India from 1996 to 2012. Nicknamed 'The Wall' for his rock-solid technique and temperament, Dravid was the backbone of India's middle order through the 2000s. He later coached India's junior teams and became head coach of the senior men's team from 2021 to 2024. He played 164 Test matches, scoring 13,288 runs, and 344 ODIs, scoring 10,889 runs. He held 210 Test catches, a world record on his retirement, and was awarded the Padma Bhushan in 2013.

VVS Laxman

VVS Laxman is a right-handed batsman who played for India from 1996 to 2012. Famed for his wristy elegance and match-saving innings, Laxman's 281 against Australia at Kolkata in 2001, alongside Rahul Dravid, is considered one of the greatest Test innings in Indian cricket history, turning around a follow-on defeat into a historic win. He played 134 Test matches, scoring 8,781 runs, and 86 ODIs, scoring 2,338 runs. He is regarded as one of India's finest players of spin bowling on turning tracks.

Anil Kumble

Anil Kumble is a leg-spin bowler who played for India from 1990 to 2008. He is India's highest wicket-taker in Test cricket and is one of only two bowlers in history to take all 10 wickets in a Test innings, achieved against Pakistan in Delhi in 1999, with figures of 10 for 74. He later captained India and served as head coach in 2016 and 2017. He played 132 Test matches, taking 619 wickets, and 271 ODIs, taking 337 wickets. He was awarded the Padma Bhushan in 2005.

Virender Sehwag

Virender Sehwag is a right-handed opening batsman who played for India from 1999 to 2013. Known as the 'Nawab of Najafgarh', Sehwag redefined Test-match opening with his fearless stroke play. He is the only Indian to score a Test triple century twice, and remains one of the fastest scorers the format has seen. He played 104 Test matches, scoring 8,586 runs, with a highest score of 319 against South Africa at Chennai in 2008. In ODIs he played 251 matches and scored 8,273 runs. He was awarded the Padma Shri in 2010.

MS Dhoni

MS Dhoni is a wicketkeeper-batsman who captained India and played from 2004 to 2019. He is one of the most successful captains in cricket history, leading India to victory in the 2007 ICC World T20, the 2011 ICC Cricket World Cup, and the 2013 ICC Champions Trophy, the only captain to win all three major ICC limited-overs titles. He is renowned for his calm demeanour, finishing ability, and lightning-fast stumpings. He played 350 ODIs, scoring 10,773 runs, and recorded 123 Test stumpings, the most by an Indian wicketkeeper. He was awarded the Padma Bhushan in 2018.

Virat Kohli

Virat Kohli is a right-handed batsman who has played for India since 2008 and captained the team from 2017 to 2022. He is regarded as one of the finest batsmen of the modern era, renowned for his relentless intensity, fitness standards, and reputation as a chase-master in ODI cricket. He has scored more than 300 ODI matches and over 14,000 ODI runs, with more than 50 ODI centuries, the most of any batsman in history. In Test cricket he has played over 110 matches and scored more than 8,000 runs. He was awarded the Padma Shri in 2017.

Rohit Sharma

Rohit Sharma is a right-handed opening batsman who has played for India since 2007 and has captained the team in white-ball cricket. Nicknamed the 'Hitman', he holds the record for the highest individual score in ODI cricket, 264 runs against Sri Lanka at Kolkata in 2014, and has scored three ODI double centuries, more than any other player. He captained India to victory in the 2024 ICC T20 World Cup and the 2025 ICC Champions Trophy, and holds the record for the most centuries by any batsman in T20 International cricket.

Jasprit Bumrah

Jasprit Bumrah is a fast bowler who has played for India since 2016. He is regarded as one of the most skillful and unorthodox fast bowlers in the world, known for his unusual bowling action, pinpoint yorkers, and mastery of death-over bowling and reverse swing across all three formats. He has been ranked the world's number one Test bowler on multiple occasions and was awarded the Arjuna Award in 2019.

Ravindra Jadeja

Ravindra Jadeja is a left-arm spin bowler and left-handed batsman who has played for India since 2009. Known for his athletic fielding, sharp spin bowling, and gritty lower-order batting, Jadeja has been one of India's most dependable all-format all-rounders, taking over 300 Test wickets and scoring more than 2,500 Test runs, in addition to over 200 ODI wickets. He is regarded as one of India's greatest fielders and was awarded the Padma Shri in 2019.

Ravichandran Ashwin

Ravichandran Ashwin is an off-spin bowler and all-rounder who played for India from 2010 to 2024. One of India's most successful spinners, Ashwin was long ranked among the world's best Test bowlers and is known for his tactical variations and sharp cricketing intellect. He retired from international cricket in 2024 with more than 500 Test wickets, among the fastest bowlers in history to reach 350, 400, and 450 Test wickets. He was awarded the Padma Shri in 2023.

Yuvraj Singh

Yuvraj Singh is a left-handed batsman and left-arm spin bowler who played for India from 2000 to 2017. A hero of India's white-ball resurgence, Yuvraj famously hit six sixes in an over against England in the 2007 T20 World Cup and was Player of the Tournament in the 2011 ICC Cricket World Cup, which he played while battling cancer, a diagnosis later revealed publicly. He played 304 ODI matches, scoring 8,701 runs, and was awarded the Padma Shri in 2012.

Zaheer Khan

Zaheer Khan is a fast bowler who played for India from 2000 to 2015. He was India's premier new-ball bowler through the 2000s and early 2010s, leading India's pace attack in the triumphant 2011 World Cup campaign, finishing as the tournament's joint-highest wicket-taker with 21 wickets. He was known for his mastery of reverse swing. He played 92 Test matches, taking 311 wickets, and 200 ODIs, taking 282 wickets. He was awarded the Arjuna Award in 2000.

Harbhajan Singh

Harbhajan Singh is an off-spin bowler who played for India from 1998 to 2016. Known as the 'Turbanator', Harbhajan became the first Indian to take a Test hat-trick, against Australia in 2001, and was instrumental in India's historic series win over Australia that year, taking 32 wickets in the three-Test series. He played 103 Test matches, taking 417 wickets, and 236 ODIs, taking 269 wickets.

Suresh Raina

Suresh Raina is a left-handed batsman and all-rounder who played for India from 2005 to 2018. A dynamic middle-order batsman and outstanding fielder, Raina was the first Indian to score centuries in all three international formats, Test, ODI, and T20I, and was a vital part of India's 2011 World Cup and 2013 Champions Trophy winning squads. He played 226 ODI matches, scoring 5,615 runs, and 78 T20 Internationals, scoring 1,605 runs.

Gautam Gambhir

Gautam Gambhir is a left-handed opening batsman who played for India from 2003 to 2016. A key opener in India's white-ball success, Gambhir top-scored in both the 2007 T20 World Cup final, with 75 runs off 54 balls, and the 2011 World Cup final, with 97 runs off 122 balls, anchoring India's chases in both title-winning matches. He played 58 Test matches, scoring 4,154 runs. He later became a coach and cricket administrator, and was awarded the Padma Shri in 2019.

Shikhar Dhawan

Shikhar Dhawan is a left-handed opening batsman who played for India from 2010 to 2022. Known as 'Gabbar', Dhawan was one of India's most consistent ODI openers, famously winning the Player of the Tournament award at the 2013 ICC Champions Trophy in only his first major ICC event, scoring 363 runs. He played 167 ODI matches, scoring 6,793 runs, and was part of India's 2013 Champions Trophy winning squad.